

Xbox Booming

The Xbox 360 debuted on November 22 in North America. 6,00,000 Xbox 360 units have been sold in the US thus far, which should easily see Microsoft through to their target of around 5 million by the end of the current business year, which ends June 30, 2006.



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Enter

Anupam Kher

Actor and Director

Anupam Kher's career spans over two decades. Actor par excellence, he has portrayed over two hundred characters since his debut in *Saraansh* (1984). Besides being on the chair for the Central Board of Film Certification, he has also acted in and produced the critically acclaimed *Maine Gandhi Ko Nahi Mara* (2005). So what does he have to say about tech?

What does technology mean to you?

Convenience is the word I would most strongly associate with technology. It has definitely made life easier.

What do your online activities entail?

Online surfing and e-mail are regular activities. I find the cell phone quite indispensable too. I also contribute to Deepak Chopra's blog.

What gadgets do you own?

I am not as tech-savvy as I would like to be. Although my mobile phone, a Sony Ericsson P900, is a gadget, I find it to be more of an everyday tool. I also own a desktop PC—a Sony Viao.

Has technology helped you in your career?

I feel contemporary courtesy the gadgets I own. It aids me in widening my horizons, both personally and in terms of my career.

WINMACS?

Windows on Apple Macs or MacOs on PCs?

Apple has just released their brand-new range of Intel-based Macs in January—a full six months ahead of schedule! We've never heard of an IT company that delivers such a large scale turnabout in architectures and OSes so far ahead of schedule, but who cares? The entire launch seems to be overshadowed by new possibilities!

Will we be able to load Windows on Macs now? What about loading Mac OS on a PC? Ever since Apple made its

announcement last year about the changeover to Intel's x86 platform, leaving its long-time partners IBM and Motorola, talks of interchanging operating systems between PCs and Macs have dominated the grapevine.

What's even cooler is that one can imagine having Mac OS and Windows XP/Vista in a dual-boot scenario.

Neither Apple nor Microsoft seems to care about any of these ideas, and Apple has specifically stated it

will not take any measures to stop those desiring to run Windows on Apple hardware. Microsoft, on the other hand, were actually happy, saying any new computers hitting the market that can potentially run Windows is good news!

What we're more interested in, however, is how fast small-time computer vendors in India will start carrying ("special") Mac OS CDs/DVDs to install for customers who want to "try" Mac OS! Since PCs are traditionally cheaper than Apple's computers, it might be Apple's turn to fight off the beast that is piracy.

Another interesting side to the release of the Intel-based Macs is the fact that they're priced identically to their former IBM/Motorola-based predecessors. One would think that with the scale at which Intel operates, their chips should be a lot cheaper! Perhaps Apple doesn't want to lose its perception of a premium product, or is thinking that existing Mac users would not be too happy if prices fell drastically. One thing's for sure: if you were thinking Macs would become more affordable, forget it—at least for now!

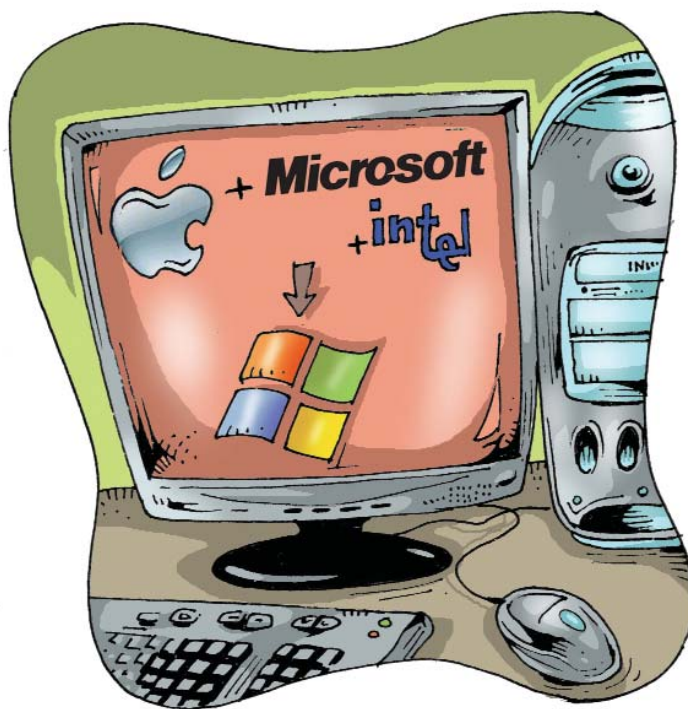


Illustration Harsho Mohan Chatterraj